PEW RESEARCH CENTER NEWS INTEREST INDEX
FEBRUARY 24-27, 2011 OMNIBUS
FINAL TOPLINE
N=1009

ASK ALL:

PEW.1 Do you approve or disapprove of the job the **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE]** are doing? **[IF DK ENTER AS DK. IF DEPENDS PROBE ONCE WITH:** Overall do you approve or disapprove of the job the **[ITEM]** are doing? **IF STILL DEPENDS ENTER AS DK]. [INTERVIEWER INSTRUCTION: REPEAT FULL QUESTION FOR NEXT ITEM]**

	Approve	Disapprove	(VOL.) DK/Ref
a. Republican leaders in Congress			
February 24-27, 2011	36	45	19
January 5-9, 2011[1]	34	43	22
November 4-7, 2010	41	37	22
Sep 30-Oct 3, 2010	24	60	16
Jul 22-25, 2010	33	53	14
Jun 16-20, 2010	31	55	14
Apr 8-11, 2010	30	56	14
Mar 10-14, 2010	25	59	16
Jan 6-10, 2010	27	57	16
Dec 9-13, 2009	29	51	20
Sep 30-Oct 4, 2009	24	60	17
Jun 10-14, 2009	29	56	15
Mar 9-12, 2009	28	51	21
Feb 4-8, 2009	34	51	15
Early October, 2006	33	56	11
June, 2006	30	53	17
March, 2006	32	50	18
January, 2006	33	52	15
Early November, 2005	33	50	17
Early October, 2005	32	52	16
Mid-September, 2005	36	49	15
Mid-May, 2005	35	50	15
Mid-March, 2005	39	44	17
Early February, 2004	41	42	17
January, 2003	48	37	15
June, 2002	50	34	16
May, 2002	49	34	17
February, 2002	56	24	20
Early September, 2001	43	39	18
June, 2001	40	40	20
May, 2001	45	36	19
April, 2001	45	30	25
January, 2001	43	36	21
July, 2000	36	46	18
May, 2000	40	42	18
March, 2000	38	43	19
February, 2000	40	43	17
January, 2000	39	41	20
December, 1999	38	42	20
October, 1999	34	50	16
Late September, 1999	34	46	20
August, 1999	40	44	16
July, 1999	36	45	19
June, 1999	37	46	17

[1] Question wording for Jan. 5-9, 2011, was: "Do you approve or disapprove of Republican congressional leaders' policies and plans for the future?".

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Approve	Disapprove	(VOL.) DK/Ref
May, 1999	38	44	18
March, 1999	38	47	15
February, 1999	37	51	12
January, 1999	38	50	12
Early December, 1998	38	49	13
November, 1998	41	48	11
Early September, 1998	44	37	19
Early August, 1998	43	37	20
June, 1998	42	38	20
May, 1998	40	41	19
April, 1998	41	40	19
March, 1998	43	39	18
January, 1998	43	41	16
November, 1997	41	43	16
August, 1997	42	44	14
June, 1997	33	50	17
May, 1997	40	44	16
April, 1997	40	44	16
February, 1997	44	42	14
January, 1997	38	47	15
December, 1996[2]	40	43	17
July, 1996	38	48	14
June, 1996	36	50	14
April, 1996	39	46	15
March, 1996	35	51	14
February, 1996	33	53	14
January, 1996	36	54	10
October, 1995	36	51	13
September, 1995	36	50	14
August, 1995	38	45	17
June, 1995	41	45	14
April, 1995	44	43	13
March, 1995	43	39	18
December, 1994	52	28	20
b. Democratic leaders in Congress			
February 24-27, 2011	33	48	19
Sep 30-Oct 3, 2010	30	53	17
Jul 22-25, 2010	35	56	10
Jun 16-20, 2010	35	53	12
Apr 8-11, 2010	38	51	11
Mar 10-14, 2010	31	57	12
Jan 6-10, 2010	35	53	11
Dec 9-13, 2009	36	47	17
Sep 30-Oct 4, 2009	33	53	15
Jun 10-14, 2009	42	45	13
Mar 9-12, 2009	47	35	18
Feb 4-8, 2009	48	38	14
August, 2008	31	58	11
January, 2008	31	53	16
November, 2007	35	50	15
October, 2007	31	54	15
July, 2007	33	54	13
June, 2007	34	49	17
April, 2007	36	43	21
March, 2007[3]	37	42	21

[2] From December, 1994, through December, 1996, the question was worded: "As best you can tell, do you approve or disapprove of the policies and proposals of the Republican leaders in Congress?".

[3] In March 2007 the question was worded: "Do you approve or disapprove of the policies and proposals of the Democratic leaders in Congress?".

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Approve	Disapprove	(VOL.) DK/Ref
February, 2007	41	36	23
Mid-January, 2007	39	34	27
November, 2006[4]	50	21	29
Early October, 2006	35	53	12
June, 2006	32	50	18
March, 2006	34	46	20
January, 2006	34	48	18
Early November, 2005	36	44	20
Early October, 2005	32	48	20
Mid-September, 2005	36	45	19
Mid-May, 2005	39	41	20
Mid-March, 2005	37	44	19
Early February, 2004	38	42	20
June, 2002	47	36	17
May, 2002	42	37	21
February, 2002	49	30	21
Early September, 2001	49	30	21
June, 2001	50	28	22
December, 1994	52	28	20

ASK ALL:

PEW.2 As I read a list of some stories covered by news organizations this past week, please tell me if you happened to follow each news story very closely, fairly closely, not too closely, or not at all closely. First, **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE;] [IF NECESSARY** "Did you follow **[ITEM]** very closely, fairly closely, not too closely or not at all closely?"**]**

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	(VOL.) DK/Ref
a. Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy					
February 24-27, 2011	49	29	11	10	*
February 17-20, 2011	35	33	14	17	*
February 10-13, 2011	36	34	13	16	*
February 3-6, 2011	35	37	14	14	*
January 20-23, 2011	37	33	14	15	1
January 13-16, 2010	37	29	15	18	1
January 6-9, 2011	39	37	11	12	1
December 16-19, 2010	39	31	14	15	2
December 9-12, 2010	39	30	14	16	1
December 2-5, 2010	52	28	11	9	*
November 18-21, 2010	46	31	11	11	*
November 11-14, 2010	38	30	15	16	1
November 4-7, 2010	44	32	11	13	*
October 28-November 1, 2010	39	34	11	15	1
October 21-24, 2010	41	29	14	14	1
October 14-17, 2010	42	33	12	13	*
October 7-10, 2010	36	33	15	15	1
September 30-October 3, 2010	43	35	10	11	1
September 23-26, 2010	43	34	13	9	1
September 16-19, 2010	37	30	16	16	1
September 2-6, 2010	43	31	13	12	*
August 19-22, 2010	39	31	14	15	1
August 5-8, 2010	39	33	14	13	1
July 29-August 1, 2010	51	33	11	5	*
July 22-25, 2010	46	33	14	6	1

[4] Question wording in November, 2006, and December, 1994, was: "As best you can tell, do you approve or disapprove of Democratic congressional leaders' policies and plans for the future?".

PEW.2 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
July 15-18, 2010	37	33	14	15	1
July 8-11, 2010	36	33	15	16	*
July 1-5, 2010	48	30	13	8	*
June 24-27, 2010	37	37	15	11	1
June 17-20, 2010	38	34	15	13	*
June 10-13, 2010	39	35	17	9	*
June 3-6, 2010	35	33	16	14	1
May 27-30, 2010	43	29	13	15	*
May 20-23, 2010	40	35	13	11	*
May 13-16, 2010	49	32	11	8	1
May 7-10, 2010	42	34	11	12	*
April 30-May 3, 2010	32	37	17	14	1
April 23-26, 2010	42	31	13	14	*
April 16-19, 2010	40	32	14	14	0
April 9-12, 2010	40	32	15	13	*
April 1-5, 2010	33	34	14	19	*
March 19-22, 2010	41	32	14	13	*
March 12-15, 2010	41	35	12	12	*
March 5-8, 2010	40	34	12	13	*
February 26-March 1, 2010	31	33	17	19	*
February 19-22, 2010	38	34	15	12	*
February 12-15, 2010	35	34	15	16	*
February 5-8, 2010	43	36	13	9	*
January 29-February 1, 2010	45	32	13	10	*
January 22-25, 2010	41	34	14	10	*
January 15-18, 2010	37	38	14	11	*
January 8-11, 2010	39	33	15	12	*
December 18-21, 2009	45	31	14	10	0
December 11-14, 2009	42	31	14	13	*
December 4-7, 2009	41	36	13	9	1
November 13-16, 2009	38	33	14	15	*
October 30-November 2, 2009	34	32	17	16	*
October 23-26, 2009	44	30	15	10	1
October 9-12, 2009	41	29	16	13	*
October 2-5, 2009	44	30	15	11	0
September 25-28, 2009	44	37	10	10	*
September 18-21, 2009	44	34	15	7	*
September 11-14, 2009	45	32	14	9	*
September 3-6, 2009	41	31	15	13	*
August 28-31, 2009	45	30	13	12	1
August 21-24, 2009	50	27	13	10	1
August 14-17, 2009	41	37	11	12	*
August 7-10, 2009	42	34	13	10	*
July 31-August 3, 2009	46	34	11	8	*
July 24-27, 2009	45	35	12	8	*
July 17-20, 2009	43	35	11	11	1
July 10-13, 2009	37	38	13	11	*
July 2-5, 2009	38	35	15	12	*
June 19-22, 2009	42	33	15	10	*
June 12-15, 2009	41	35	12	12	*
June 5-8, 2009	41	34	11	14	*
May 29-June 1, 2009	43	37	11	8	*
May 21-24, 2009	44	35	13	9	*
May 15-18, 2009	44	35	12	8	*
May 8-11, 2009	42	34	12	12	*
May 1-4, 2009	47	36	11	5	1
April 17-20, 2009	52	30	10	7	1
April 9-13, 2009	48	29	13	10	0
March 27-30, 2009	48	32	10	10	*

PEW.2 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
March 20-23, 2009	52	34	8	6	*
March 13-16, 2009	48	33	9	10	*
February 27-March 2, 2009	56	30	8	6	*
February 13-16, 2009	55	29	10	6	*
January 30-February 2, 2009	52	31	12	5	*
January 23-26, 2009	57	30	8	5	0
January 16-19, 2009	43	35	13	9	*
January 2-4, 2009	42	36	15	7	*
December 12-15, 2008	51	33	9	7	*
December 5-8, 2008	42	38	13	7	*
November 21-24, 2008	59	24	9	8	*
November 14-17, 2008	56	29	9	6	*
November 7-10, 2008	54	31	8	7	*
October 31-November 3, 2008	63	27	6	4	*
October 24-27, 2008	52	35	7	5	1
October 17-20, 2008	62	29	6	3	*
October 10-13, 2008	65	25	7	3	*
October 3-6, 2008	69	23	5	3	*
September 26-29, 2008	70	22	5	3	*
September 19-22, 2008	56	27	12	5	*
September 5-8, 2008	44	33	16	7	*
August 29-31, 2008	41	34	13	11	1
August 15-18, 2008	39	36	15	10	*
August 8-11, 2008	39	35	16	10	*
August 1-4, 2008	47	34	11	8	0
July 25-28, 2008	46	32	10	12	*
July 18-21, 2008	45	33	13	9	*
July 11-14, 2008	44	33	12	10	1
June 27-30, 2008	49	31	12	7	1
June 13-16, 2008	42	33	14	11	*
May 9-12, 2008	45	31	13	11	*
May 2-5, 2008	43	31	15	10	1
April 18-21, 2008	41	35	13	10	1
April 4-7, 2008	39	37	12	12	*
March 28-31, 2008	42	36	14	8	*
March 20-24, 2008	45	33	13	9	*
February 29-March 3, 2008	38	35	15	11	1
February 15-18, 2008	37	36	11	16	8
February 1-4, 2008	40	37	14	8	1
January 18-21, 2008	42	31	16	11	*
January 11-14, 2008	36	32	15	16	1
November 2-5, 2007	27	37	16	19	1
October 19-22, 2007	25	34	20	21	*
August 10-13, 2007	28	36	18	18	*
Mid-November, 2006	31	40	17	11	1
December, 2005	35	35	18	11	1
Early November, 2005	35	39	17	9	*
Mid-May, 2005	30	39	19	11	1
January, 2005	35	41	17	7	*
Mid-October, 2004	30	43	16	10	1
Early September, 2004	39	34	15	11	1
Mid-January, 2004	37	41	15	7	*
December, 2003	35	38	14	11	2
November, 2003	40	34	15	10	1
October, 2003	32	39	16	12	1
September, 2003	39	30	18	12	1
March, 2003	40	35	16	8	1
February, 2003	42	33	15	10	*
December, 2002	38	34	17	10	1

PEW.2 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
February, 2002	35	40	15	9	1
January, 2002	30	44	16	9	1
December, 2001	37	40	13	8	2
Mid-November, 2001	41	36	15	7	1
June, 2001	24	41	18	16	1
May, 2001	34	36	15	15	0
April, 2001	36	34	16	13	1
February, 2001	30	39	18	12	1
January, 2001	32	38	17	11	2
June, 1995	26	41	22	11	*
March, 1995	27	45	19	9	*
February, 1995	23	41	22	13	1
December, 1994	28	43	20	9	*
October, 1994	27	40	20	12	1
June, 1994	25	42	23	10	*
May, 1994	33	40	16	10	1
January, 1994	34	39	16	10	1
Early January, 1994	36	44	13	7	*
December, 1993	35	41	15	8	1
October, 1993	33	38	20	9	*
September, 1993	37	40	14	8	1
Early September, 1993	39	39	14	9	*
August, 1993	41	36	14	9	*
May, 1993	37	38	18	6	1
February, 1993	49	36	10	5	*
January, 1993	42	39	12	7	*
September, 1992	43	37	13	6	1
May, 1992	39	39	15	6	1
March, 1992	47	38	11	4	*
February, 1992	47	37	10	6	*
January, 1992	44	40	11	5	*
October, 1991	36	38	16	9	1
b. Disputes in Wisconsin and other states between state governments and public employee unions					
February 24-27, 2011	36	22	15	26	1
c. Growing violence in Libya					
February 24-27, 2011	38	30	15	16	*
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON					
February 17-20, 2011: *News about the situation in Egypt*	34	32	17	16	1
February 17-20, 2011: *Anti-government protests in other Middle Eastern and North African nations*	20	30	22	28	1
February 10-13, 2011: *Anti-government protests in Egypt and the resignation of President Hosni Mubarak*	39	31	14	15	1
February 3-6, 2011: *Anti-government protests in Egypt and other Middle Eastern countries*	32	35	16	18	*
January 27-30, 2011	17	26	21	35	*
January 20-23, 2011: *Political instability in Tunisia following the collapse of the government*	7	15	25	53	1
January 13-16, 2010: *The collapse of the Lebanese government*	4	11	20	64	*

PEW.2 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
May 20-23, 2010: *A government crackdown on protestors in Thailand*	7	14	27	52	1
July 31-August 3, 2009: *The Iranian government's crackdown on opposition protestors*	18	23	26	31	2
July 2-5, 2009: *News about controversy surrounding the recent Iranian election*	22	31	23	23	*
June 26-29, 2009: *The Iranian government's crackdown on election protestors*	31	27	18	23	1
June 19-22, 2009: *Protests in Iran over disputed elections*	28	28	21	22	1
March 20-24, 2008: *Violent protests in Tibet against the Chinese government*	12	27	26	35	*
September 28-October 1, 2007: *Pro-democracy protests by Buddhist monks in Burma*	13	27	20	39	1
March 17-21, 2005: *Protests and political changes in Lebanon*	10	28	25	36	1
January 6-11, 2004: *Reports that Libya will end its weapons program and cooperate with UN inspectors*	14	30	28	27	1
October 6-8, 2000: *Civil unrest and rioting in Belgrade, Yugoslavia*	18	27	24	31	*
January 9-12, 1997: *Protests and demonstrations in Belgrade against Serbian President Milosevic*	7	14	29	49	1
July 10-24, 1986: *The U.S. air strike against Libya*	58	27	11	3	1
d. A major earthquake in New Zealand February 24-27, 2011	20	30	26	23	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
October 28-November 1, 2010: *A tsunami and a volcano erupting in Indonesia*	11	25	27	36	1
March 12-15, 2010: Major aftershocks in Chile following an earthquake in late February	18	41	27	14	*
March 5-8, 2010: *A major earthquake in Chile*	27	42	19	12	*
February 19-22, 2010: *Haiti releasing most of the Americans who were accused of attempted kidnapping*	16	30	29	23	*
February 12-15, 2010: *The aftermath of a major earthquake and relief efforts in Haiti*	37	37	17	8	*
February 5-8, 2010	42	39	13	6	*
January 29-February 1, 2010	45	38	13	4	*
January 22-25, 2010	50	40	8	3	*
January 15-18, 2010: *A major earthquake in Haiti*	60	28	8	4	*
August 14-17, 2009: *A typhoon that caused flooding and mudslides in Taiwan*	7	21	30	41	1
April 9-13, 2009: *A major earthquake in Italy*	18	35	25	22	*
May 16-19, 2008: *The earthquake in China*	30	41	17	12	*
May 9-12, 2008: *Reports about the cyclone that hit Burma*	23	35	23	19	*
November 2-5, 2007: *The impact of Hurricane Noel on the Bahamas and Cuba*	11	22	31	35	1

PEW.2 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
September 7-10, 2007: *The impact of Hurricanes Felix and Henriette on Mexico and Central America*	14	29	29	27	1
August 24-27, 2007: *The destruction caused by Hurricane Dean in Mexico and the Caribbean*	18	39	24	18	1
October, 2005: *The earthquake in Pakistan*	22	39	23	16	*
January 2005: *The earthquake and tsunami in the Indian Ocean*	58	32	7	3	*
January 2004: *The earthquake in Iran*	16	34	31	19	*
February 2001: *The earthquake in India*	15	33	31	20	1
March 2000: *Flood rescue efforts in Mozambique*	10	26	30	34	*
September 1999: *The earthquake in Turkey*	27	37	23	12	1
November 1998: *Hurricane Mitch and the rain and mudslides in Central America*	36	36	16	11	1
February 1995: *The earthquake in Japan*	25	47	20	8	*
May 1991: *The cyclone that devastated Bangladesh*	23	36	23	17	1
July 1990: *The earthquake in Iran*	20	36	28	16	*
e. Recent developments in the debate over gay marriage					
February 24-27, 2011	19	26	20	34	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
May 29-June 1, 2009: *The California Supreme Court upholding a ban on gay marriage*	22	35	19	23	1
May 8-11, 2009: *Steps to legalize gay marriage in Maine and New Hampshire*	16	16	22	45	1
April 9-13, 2009: *The legalization of gay marriage in Iowa and Vermont*	13	21	23	42	1
Nov. 7-10, 2008: *California voting to ban gay marriage*	18	26	24	32	*
June 20-23, 2008: *The issue of same-sex marriage in California*	22	26	25	27	*
May 16-19, 2008: *The California Supreme Court's decision giving same-sex couples the right to marry*	19	27	25	28	1
May 2004: *The issue of gay and lesbian marriage*	20	27	25	27	1
March 2004: *The issue of gay and lesbian marriage*	29	33	20	17	1
Early-February 2004: *The debate about letting gays and lesbians marry*	26	32	22	19	1
Mid-August 2003: *The debate about letting gays and lesbians marry*	19	30	22	28	1
f. The rising price of oil					
February 24-27, 2011	50	29	13	8	*
June 27-30, 2008	57	26	11	5	1
March 7-10, 2008	43	33	12	11	1
November 9-12, 2007	44	28	14	13	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
October 17-20, 2008: *The falling price of gas and oil*	53	33	11	3	*
July 3-7, 2008: *The rising price of gasoline*	62	25	8	4	1
June 6-9, 2008	66	19	7	7	1

PEW.2 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
May 22-25, 2008	65	22	9	4	*
May 16-19, 2008	64	21	10	4	1
May 2-5, 2008	63	23	9	4	1
April 25-28, 2008	62	23	10	5	*
May 24-27, 2007	52	29	10	8	1
May 18-21, 2007[5]	48	27	16	8	1
August, 2006[6]	60	26	7	5	2
June, 2006	58	26	10	5	1
May, 2006	69	21	6	3	1
April, 2006	65	22	8	4	1
December, 2005	61	27	7	4	1
Early November, 2005	61	27	9	2	1
Late October, 2005	67	23	7	3	*
Early October, 2005	65	25	6	3	1
Early September, 2005	71	19	7	3	*
Mid-May, 2005	58	27	9	5	1
Mid-March, 2005	50	32	13	5	*
Mid-October, 2004	64	22	8	5	1
August, 2004	52	29	10	8	1
July, 2004	56	25	11	7	1
June, 2004	58	26	9	6	1
April, 2004	46	30	15	8	1
Early April, 2004	58	23	10	8	1
Mid-March, 2004	47	27	14	10	2
September, 2003	45	27	15	11	1
March, 2003	52	27	11	9	1
February, 2003	53	25	12	9	1
June, 2001	56	31	7	5	1
May, 2001	61	26	6	6	1
Early October, 2000	56	25	12	6	1
June, 2000	61	25	9	5	*
March, 2000	58	28	10	4	*
October, 1990	62	26	8	4	*
September, 1990	56	28	11	5	*
August, 1990	57	27	10	5	1

ASK ALL:

PEW.3 Which ONE of the stories I just mentioned have you followed most closely, or is there another story you've been following MORE closely? [**DO NOT READ LIST. ACCEPT ONLY ONE RESPONSE.]**

Feb 24-27 2011	
21	The rising price of oil
19	Growing violence in Libya
18	Disputes in Wisconsin and other states between state governments and public employee unions
14	Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy
5	A major earthquake in New Zealand
4	Recent developments in the debate over gay marriage
9	Some other story **(VOL.)**
11	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

[5] For May 18-21, 2007 the item was not asked as part of a list.

[6] From October, 2000 to August, 2006, the story was listed as "The high price of gasoline these days." From August, 1990 to June, 2000, the story was listed as "Recent increases in the price of gasoline."

ASK ALL:

PEW. 4 From what you've read and heard about the dispute between Wisconsin's governor and public employee unions over collective bargaining rights, do you side more with **[READ AND RANDOMIZE]**?

Feb 24-27 2011	
31	The governor
42	The public employee unions
9	Neither **(VOL.)**
18	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

TREND FOR COMPARISON:

*How about when you hear of a disagreement between state or local governments and unions that represent government workers, is your first reaction **[READ AND RANDOMIZE]**?*

	Feb 2-7 2011
To side with the governments	38
To side with the unions	44
Both/Neither **(VOL.)**	3
Depends **(VOL.)**	5
Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	10

ASK ALL:

PEW.5 How much if anything, have you heard about each of the following? Have you heard a lot, a little or nothing at all? **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE ITEMS a AND b, WITH ITEM c ALWAYS LAST]**

	A lot	A little	Nothing at all	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. Toyota's recall of about 2 million vehicles				
February 24-27, 2011	29	45	26	*
b. Somali pirates hijacking an American yacht and killing four hostages				
February 24-27, 2011	41	40	18	1
c. The possibility that the federal government might shut down this year if Republicans and the Obama administration can't agree on a budget				
February 24-27, 2011	37	34	29	*
February 17-20, 2011[7]	21	35	44	*

[7] The wording for February 17-20, 2011, was: "The possibility that the federal government might shut down this year if Congress and President Obama can't agree on a budget."

ASK ALL:

PEW.6 If the federal government shuts down because **[RANDOMIZE:** Republicans and the Obama administration**]** can't agree on a budget, who do you think would be more to blame: **[READ IN SAME ORDER AS ABOVE:** Republicans or the Obama administration**]**?[8]

Feb 24-27 2011	
36	Republicans
35	The Obama administration
17	Both equally **(VOL.)**
1	Neither **(VOL.)**
10	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:

There's a possibility the federal government might have to shut down in the next few days because the Clinton Administration and the Republicans in Congress can't agree on a plan to keep it running while they work on a new budget. Whose fault do you think this mainly is—Clinton's or the Republicans' in Congress?

	ABC News/Washington Post Nov 10-13 1995
Clinton	27
Republicans	46
Both **(VOL.)**	20
Neither **(VOL.)**	2
No opinion	5

As you may know, the federal government has shut down many of its operations because the Clinton Administration and the Republicans in Congress have not agreed on a plan to keep it running while they work on a new budget. Whose fault do you think this mainly is—Clinton's or the Republicans' in Congress?

	ABC News Jan 3 1996	*ABC News/ Washington Post* Nov 19 1995
Clinton	25	24
Republicans	44	51
Both **(VOL.)**	24	20
Neither **(VOL.)**	3	1
No opinion	3	4

[8] PEW.6 asked in conjunction with *The Washington Post*.